

JOSHUA HIMMENS

Engineering Physics Student

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EDUCATION

University of British Columbia

Vancouver, BC, Canada

Bachelor of Applied Science in Engineering Physics

Sep 2023 – May 2028

- Capstone projects: Built an ML-controlled dual-arm napkin-folding robot and co-designed a 5x5 phased-array sonar with 24 receive channels and FPGA-based simultaneous beamforming.
- Specialized in entrepreneurship, machine learning, quantum computing, robotics, and embedded systems.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Tesla

Palo Alto, CA, USA

Tactile Sensing Engineering Intern, Optimus

May 2025 – Dec 2025

- Designed tactile sensors using data-driven models to guide sensor architecture and manufacturing specifications.
- Collaborated on neural and classical physics models for Optimus tactile sensors.
- Characterized tactile sensors, defined test specification limits for incoming samples, and collaborated on test infrastructure design.

AltaML

Calgary, AB, Canada

Associate Machine Learning Developer

Jan 2025 – Apr 2025

- Developed machine learning models using scikit-learn to save the Government of Alberta >\$4 million annually.
- Developed novel evaluation metrics to minimize regional bias and maximize transferability of models.
- Built Azure ML pipelines for automated model training and deployment, serving predictions via REST APIs integrated with SQL databases and Blob Storage.
- Implemented Uber's H3 hexagonal spatial indexing to balance geographic accuracy with user privacy in an infrastructure planning tool.

TRIUMF

Vancouver, BC, Canada

ATLAS Deep Learning Research Student

May 2024 – Feb 2025

- Developed panoptic segmentation models for the ATLAS detector using the PointNet ML framework with wandb, TensorFlow, Keras.
- Used CERN's grid computing to parallelize compute across thousands of nodes.
- Worked independently to develop models using cutting-edge transfer learning approaches.
- Implemented models into production using NVIDIA Triton.

UBC Orbit Satellite Design Team

Vancouver, BC, Canada

Command and Data Handling (CDH) Lead and Firmware Developer

Oct 2023 – Present

- Led the CDH team to develop software to meet mission and testing objectives from ESA (European Space Agency) for the ALEASAT project.
- Managed a team of 10 firmware developers, with over \$15 000 worth of technical infrastructure.
- Developed mission testing, function testing, and acceptance testing procedures to meet ESA and ECSS standards.
- Programmed device drivers and electrical ground support equipment (EGSE).

Embedded Firmware Developer

Jan 2023 – Present

- Programmed device drivers, electrical ground support equipment (EGSE).
- Developed the ALEASAT Avionics Test Bench (FlatSat).
- Worked on the ALEASAT onboard computing system using FreeRTOS on a TMS570 microcontroller.

PUBLICATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

Machine Learning for Robotic Napkin Folding at 2026 IEEE Vancouver Section AGM

Mar 2026

- Placed 3rd. Explored various policies on SO-101 arms.

Developing Machine Learning Techniques for Particle Flow in the ATLAS Experiment at Canadian Astroparticle Physics Summer Student Talks Competition (CASST 2024)

Jun 2024

- Placed 2nd of 44 presentations.

JetPointNet: A Machine Learning Approach to Cell-to-Track Attribution in the ATLAS Experiment at Canadian Undergraduate Physics Conference

Oct 2024

3D Particle Flow in the ATLAS Calorimeter: How to Train Your Model at TRIUMF Science Week

May 2024

HONORS AND AWARDS

2026 Design & Innovation Day Faculty Award

Issued by *UBC Faculty of Applied Science*

Apr 2026

- Earned one of three Faculty Awards for Linique, a dual-arm napkin-folding robot powered by a four-camera learned controller and vision-language-action model; contributed improvements to the open-source LeRobot framework.

Hector J. MacLeod Award

Issued by *IEEE Vancouver Section*

Apr 2024

- Awarded to students who have demonstrated pioneering efforts in their chosen field of study and attained high scholastic honours.

Erich Vogt First Year Summer Research Experience (FYSRE) Award

Issued by *UBC Department of Physics and Astronomy*

May 2024

- Awarded to promising students in physics for a 4-month research placement.

Alberta Centennial Award and Alberta Premier's Citizenship Award

Issued by *Government of Alberta*

May 2023

- Awarded for outstanding community service.

Calgary Flames Foundation Community Involvement Scholarship

Issued by *Education Matters*

Aug 2023

- Awarded for community involvement.

Julia Turnbull Leadership Award for exceptional community service

Issued by *The Calgary Foundation*

Jul 2023

- Awarded for exceptional community service.

LEADERSHIP AND ADVOCACY

Chair

UBC IEEE Aerospace Electrical Systems Student Branch Chapter

Vancouver

Aug 2025 – May 2026

- Served as **Technical Program Chair** for the Student Aerospace Summit, September 2025.
- Organized events to unify aerospace-interested students across UBC.

Advisory Team Member

Child Rights Connect

Geneva, Switzerland (remote)

Jan 2021 – Dec 2023

- Provided guidance to UN delegations on communication strategies for high-level rights goals.
- Presented to governments and consulted on international initiatives to support the UN Convention on the Rights of the Child.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Machine Learning:** TensorFlow, Keras, PointNet, Weights and Biases (wandb), ONNX, LeRobot, Runpod, Triton
- **Embedded Programming:** Experienced with FreeRTOS on TMS570, RP2040, STM32, Xilinx and Altera FPGAs, KiCAD
- **Software Development:** Python, Rust, C, C++, Java, MATLAB, Bash, Git
- **Quantum Computing:** Qiskit, QASM, Pasqal, QCNNs, VQCs
- **Particle Physics:** ROOT, CERN grid computing, Athena

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **FizzVolt, HUD RL for Hardware Hackathon (HUD):** Built a GRPO reinforcement-learning environment that trains Qwen3 models to generate KiCad circuit designs using deterministic electrical-rule, cost, size, and availability validators as the reward
- **Quantum School for Young Students** (University of Waterloo and Institute for Quantum Computing): Participant in intensive quantum computing program
- **GENQ Global Hackathon (Geneva, 2025 and Calgary, 2024)** (Quantum AI Ventures): Build QCNNs and QUBO solvers for quantum machine learning tasks